

Legislative Advocacy & Coalition Building

Learner guide | SWP-029 | School of Social Policy & Advocacy

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Legislative Advocacy & Coalition Building. By the end of the course, you should be able to plan ethical, evidence-informed advocacy to influence legislation and public decisions.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Plan ethical, evidence-informed advocacy to influence legislation and public decisions.
- Apply the key ideas from Legislative landscape.
- Apply the key ideas from Advocacy strategy.
- Apply the key ideas from Campaign delivery.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Legislative landscape	how bills move, decision makers, committees, timing, and jurisdiction	10 to 15 minutes
2. Advocacy strategy	power mapping, coalition roles, messages, meetings, public engagement, and ethics	10 to 15 minutes
3. Campaign delivery	briefing decision makers, mobilising constituents, monitoring outcomes, and adaptation	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Legislative landscape

This module focuses on how bills move, decision makers, committees, timing, and jurisdiction. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- How bills move
- Decision makers
- Committees
- Timing
- Jurisdiction

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of legislative landscape in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of how bills move, decision makers, committees, timing, and jurisdiction. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through legislative landscape safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Advocacy strategy

This module focuses on power mapping, coalition roles, messages, meetings, public engagement, and ethics. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Power mapping
- Coalition roles
- Messages
- Meetings
- Public engagement
- Ethics

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of advocacy strategy in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of power mapping, coalition roles, messages, meetings, public engagement, and ethics. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through advocacy strategy safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Campaign delivery

This module focuses on briefing decision makers, mobilising constituents, monitoring outcomes, and adaptation. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Briefing decision makers
- Mobilising constituents
- Monitoring outcomes
- Adaptation

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of campaign delivery in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of briefing decision makers, mobilising constituents, monitoring outcomes, and adaptation. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through campaign delivery safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: legislative process.
- Review the distinction between: strategy.
- Review the distinction between: coalition practice.
- Review the distinction between: ethical lobbying.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.